

What this is

The file the PM5 saved one minute after today's DSP crash, pried open out of curiosity. A **.RIVAGEPM** file is a Yamaha "MBDF Project File" — a proprietary container, but its payload is ordinary zlib compression, so the text layer comes out with a dozen lines of Python. Parameter values (faders, EQ curves, routing grids) are packed binary with no public spec — those stay Yamaha's secret.

File anatomy

On disk	2,879,432 bytes, magic header "#YAMAHA MBDFProjectFile" + a Rivage platform tag
Compressed streams	190 separate zlib blocks found by signature scan
Backup generations	THREE complete console-state backups nested inside one save (2.55 MB, 2.55 MB, 3.18 MB compressed; the newest inflates to 3.96 MB). The console hoards its own history.
Also inside	A ProjectInfo block with an MD5-style fingerprint, and dozens of small "MBDFPreset" blocks (the scene/library entries, ~1.5-6 KB each)

The console's own Dante phonebook

The save carries the console's mounted-device table — and it matches the KB's Dante Device Register exactly:

Y005-S-Rio3224-F0H (Rio3224-D, Stephenson F0H)
Y007-S-Rio3224-Band-01 (Rio3224-D2, pit band 1)
Y008-S-Rio3224-Band-02 (Rio3224-D2, pit band 2)
Y009-Stephenson-AmpRoom1608D2 (the one true Rio1608-D2, ER1 amp room)
Y021-Y028 AXIENTS-1-32 (the Shure AD4Q receiver banks)
S-ME1s-AHhub (the Allen & Heath ME-U personal-mixer hub)
STEPH-NUENDO (virtual soundcheck machine, 10.18.10.202)
HY144-D / HY144-D-SRC (the HY slot cards themselves)

Names in the machine

User channel labels	VALJEAN, EPONINE, Caelan, Kevin T, Kevin J, Claude, ENS - band-member and principal names matching the workbook's input list
Custom fader banks	"Jess Mix" (the A1's bank), Band 2, Band 3, Custom1D, Custom1E, Efx/Buss
UDK-ish labels	PANIC, DOWN, TOGGLE, PINK NOISE - consistent with the QLab UDK bank documented in the workbook
Ghosts of shows past	DANIELLE, HENRY, RODMILLA - Ever After characters still living in the preset library. Your Les Mis file has Ever After DNA.
Factory name dictionary	Yamaha ships a built-in suggestion list: Pastor, Priest, Minister, Podium, Popstar, Camcoder, Money(!) - all present in every save

Numbers that amused me

13,824 x "SOFT-2" (EQ library grid entries)
4,608 x "BELL" (EQ band-type fields)
4,599 x "SELF POST EQ" (dynamics key-source defaults)
2,304 x "Classic Comp" (compressor model defaults)
108 x PortName/SignalName pairs (Dante port map)
37 x IPv4Address fields + 29 SubnetMask + 53 DHCP flags
2 x DuganAutomixer blocks

1 x "Jess Mix" (there is only one Jess)

Verdict

Readable: the entire label layer - device mounts, channel/bank/library names, schema structure. Not readable: any actual mix data. To audit parameters you still need the console or PM Editor. But as a "what did this save actually contain" fingerprint - device mounts intact, banks intact, names intact - it confirms the 13:30:55 post-crash save captured a complete console state. Filed under: things we now know because the DSP had a bad day.